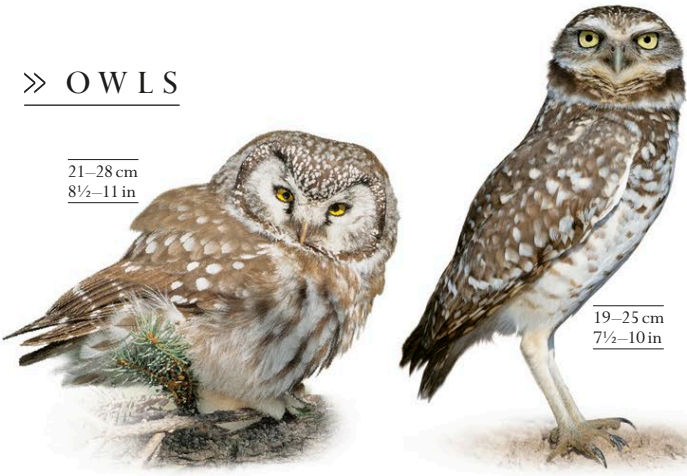


» OWLS



21–28 cm
8½–11 in

19–25 cm
7½–10 in

TENGMALM'S OWL
Aegolius funereus
F: Strigidae

This owl of northern circumpolar forests is adept at locating small mammals under snow. It hunts during daylight.

BURROWING OWL
Athene cunicularia
F: Strigidae

A long-legged owl, this partly diurnal species inhabits grassland and deserts across the Americas, nesting in burrows of prairie dogs or other animals.

LONG-EARED OWL
Asio otus
F: Strigidae

Found in forests and heathland through much of the northern hemisphere, this owl can flatten its long ear tufts, rendering them invisible.

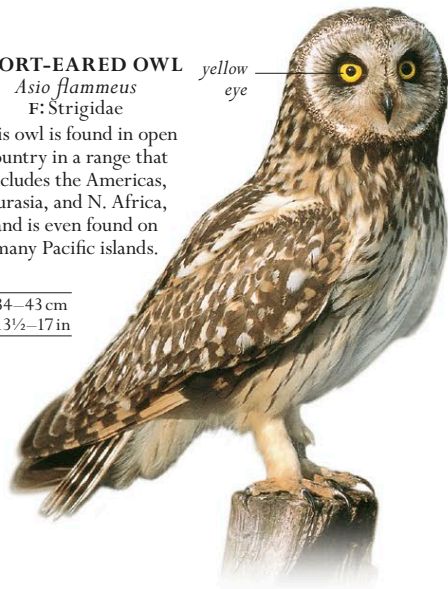
31–37 cm
12–14½ in



SHORT-EARED OWL
Asio flammeus
F: Strigidae

This owl is found in open country in a range that includes the Americas, Eurasia, and N. Africa, and is even found on many Pacific islands.

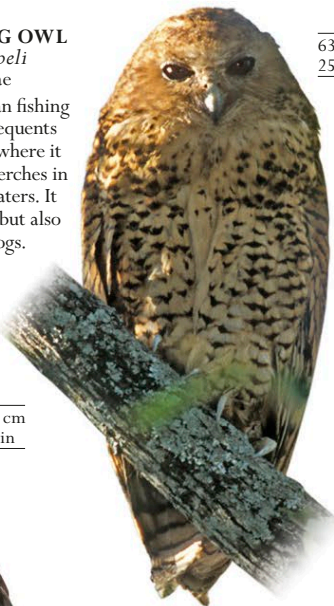
34–43 cm
13½–17 in



PEL'S FISHING OWL
Scotopelia peli
F: Strigidae

The largest African fishing owl, this bird frequents riverside forest, where it hunts from low perches in slow-running waters. It eats mainly fish, but also crabs and frogs.

63–65 cm
25–26 in



pale brown,
heart-shaped face

yellow
eye

heavily streaked
upperparts



30–35 cm
12–14 in

MOREPORK
Ninox novaeseelandiae
F: Strigidae

Typical of Australasian hawk-owls, this bird has large, yellow eyes. Unusually for owls, the male of the species is larger than the female.

barred
underparts



38 cm
15 in

BLACK-AND-WHITE OWL

Ciccaba nigrolineata
F: Strigidae

This barred owl of dense tropical forests from Mexico to Ecuador is a close relative of the *Strix* wood owls.

BARKING OWL
Ninox connivens
F: Strigidae

Found from the Moluccas, Indonesia, to Australia, this woodland hawk-owl is named for its dog-like barking call.

38–43 cm
15–17 in



MESITES

These small, insectivorous birds of forest and scrub in Madagascar are flightless, or almost so.

In the family Mesitornithidae, mesites resemble passerines in their use of song for territorial defence, but they are social birds. Small groups often feed, rest, and preen together. Two species of the family are monogamous and their sexes look alike, while one is polygamous, with marked differences between the male and the female bird.

PHYLUM	CHORDATA
CLASS	AVES
ORDER	MESITORNITHIFORMES
FAMILIES	1
SPECIES	3



31 cm
12 in

WHITE-BREASTED MESITE

Mesitornis variegatus
F: Mesitornithidae

This bird is found in three isolated areas of undisturbed deciduous forest where small groups forage amongst leaf litter on the ground for insects, spiders, and seeds.